



Healthcare – Advocacy – Volunteerism – Education – Neighborhood

Volunteer Opportunities at HAVEN

About HAVEN Free Clinic

HAVEN Free Clinic is a student-run clinic affiliated with Yale University to advance access to sustainable, comprehensive, and high-quality care for uninsured adults in New Haven. Hundreds of volunteers across more than a dozen clinical and non-clinical departments support patients seeking primary care, reproductive health, medical debt relief, and other ancillary services that expand access to care through community partners and specialty services.

Volunteers come from every corner of Yale: the Medical School, School of Management, School of Public Health, Yale College, studying everything from medicine to history to physics. If you want to be a part of something that gives back directly to New Haven and work that is bigger than any one discipline, there is a place for you here.

There are many ways to get involved at HAVEN! Descriptions of each department are provided below. Please feel free to contact the Student Relations Department at hfc.recruitment@yale.edu for general volunteer information.

The expected volunteer commitment is at least four times over the term.

IMPORTANT: Please note that only volunteers in good standing who have met the expectations of their department directors will be given priority to continue in their current volunteer positions. In addition, returning volunteers who wish to change departments, although the switch is not guaranteed, those in good standing will receive priority over new volunteers.

Applications are open for the following departments:

- Behavioral Health
- Care Coordination
 - Patient Navigator
 - Transfer of Care
- Education
- Food Pharmacy
- Infectious and Chronic Disease Department
- Interpreting
- Medical Debt and Insurance Counseling
- Medication Access
- Oral Health Department
- Patient Services
- Phlebotomy
- Primary Care
 - Senior Clinical Team Member
 - Junior Clinical Team Member
- Quality Assurance/Quality Improvement
- Referrals
- Reproductive Health
 - Senior Clinical Team Member
 - Junior Clinical Team Member
- Social Services
- Vaccines
 - Administrator
 - Coordinator

Department	Description	Who Can Apply
Behavioral Health [BVHD]	The Behavioral Health Department (BHD) is an educational program designed to offer timely and relevant mental health resources to patients engaged in care at HAVEN. The primary care setting is a common entry point into the healthcare system and a place where emotional stress is first identified and recognized by providers. BHD does not offer psychiatric treatment but rather intends to empower patients with information about how emotional well-being represents an important dimension of overall wellness. BHD also seeks to support volunteers throughout HAVEN with information on recognizing and responding to behavioral health concerns. Volunteers work in collaboration with licensed faculty advisors (clinical psychologists and psychiatrists). All volunteers receive tailored training to common health-related social needs among patients served at HAVEN. Continued education and skill building related to rapport building, active listening, and empathy are highly emphasized in BHD and when interacting with patients in clinic. In addition, student volunteers are trained in recognizing signs of emotional distress, identifying sources of resilience, natural support, and initiating referrals to community-based providers when necessary for patients. Opportunities are also available to co-lead monthly group educational sessions and/or participate in ongoing research projects related to the delivery of behavioral health education and support in a primary care student-run setting.	Any Yale student; those with prior experience delivering educational curricula, particularly if health-related, or those with a specific interest in mental/behavioral health have found the program to be an especially good fit. Medical, nursing, and PA students are highly encouraged to apply. Fluency in Spanish is strongly preferred. Volunteers who can commit for at least two terms will be prioritized. Attendance at trainings (may be virtual or in-person) and weekly team meetings is required for all volunteers unless alternative arrangements have been discussed. Weekly meetings will be on Thursday evenings. During these meetings, volunteers will be provided the opportunity to present their patients from clinic as a continued learning opportunity for the BHD community. Weekly meetings may also consist of didactic psychoeducation presentations led by our faculty advisors.
Care Coordination - Patient Navigator [PNLC]	Many HAVEN patients face multiple challenges in accessing quality healthcare, from transportation and language barriers to a lack of support in navigating a complex healthcare system. The Patient Navigator Volunteer (PNV) program aims to empower patients and provide them with the support they need to access care at HAVEN and in the larger healthcare system. Each PNV works closely with several patients longitudinally and plays a key role in identifying barriers to their care. PNVs help address these barriers by connecting patients with the resources they need and empowering them with the skills and confidence to navigate their own healthcare. Much of the work is done outside of clinic hours - volunteers will call patients to discuss their goals, liaise with other HAVEN departments and outside	Any member of the Yale community, no clinical experience required. Fluency in Spanish preferred but not required. Volunteers who can stay on for at least 2 terms will be given priority (please mention this in your application)

	providers to ensure patients receive the resources they require, and facilitate appropriate check-ins between appointments. PNVs will be expected to accompany patients to their HAVEN appointments, and they may also coordinate specialist appointments for patients. The overall goal of the PNV program is to help patients gain the skills and resources they need to take control of their health and wellbeing.	
Care Coordination – Transfer of Care [PNTC]	The Transfer of Care program aims to empower patients and provide them with the support they need as they transition outside of HAVEN. Transfer of Care volunteers facilitate the transfer process for patients who meet the criteria for transitioning to ensure a warm handoff. Volunteer responsibilities are to track the progress of specific panels of transfer of care patients which includes discussing the transfer of care process with the patient, calling outside clinics to establish appointments, and liaising with other HAVEN medical/ancillary departments to facilitate smooth transitions to clinics outside of HAVEN. Much of the work will be done outside clinic hours with LCC directors' support. Volunteers are expected to have touch points with their patient panels, directors, and other departments working with your patients weekly to ensure constant and consistent care. The Transfer of Care program aims to ensure a smooth transition to long-term care providers and help patients access resources needed to take control of their health and well-being.	Any Yale student, no prior clinical experience required. Fluency in Spanish preferred but not required. Volunteers who can stay on for at least 2 terms will be given priority (please mention this in your application).
Education [EDUC]	The Education Department provides one-on-one counseling on health and wellness, tailoring plans to patients' individual needs. We work with a variety of patients with chronic conditions, including diabetes, hypertension, and hyperlipidemia. In addition, we also create educational materials and assist patients with financial needs for maintaining a healthy diet. All volunteers have opportunities to learn and practice motivational interviewing and counseling skills that will be invaluable in the health professions and many other fields. Volunteers must be available for at least 5 shifts per term, and willing to complete minor tasks outside of the clinic (5 hours/term), including mandatory in-person training sessions. Volunteers must be available to volunteer the entirety of their shift (from 8 am to 1 pm).	Any member of the Yale community. Relevant clinical experience is preferred for application. If you are able to volunteer for more than one term/the summer, that is a plus.
Food Pharmacy [FOOD]	The Food Pharmacy is a new initiative at the Yale School of Medicine started in 2023 to increase access to healthy food for the patients at HAVEN Free Clinic. The Food Pharmacy will partner with HAVEN to supply healthy groceries and nutritional education to patients	Priority will be given to individuals looking to volunteer for multiple years.

	experiencing food insecurity following their clinic visits. This year, we are conducting a study to investigate how the food pharmacy can prevent progression in chronic disease states. Volunteers will help start this new initiative with the opportunity to publish papers and influence Food is Medicine policy across the country. Follow the link for more details about the Food Pharmacy: https://docs.google.com/document/d/1sZw1iS71PBiVyzEXqQ9HQU4sDKtb8wX9WsWeO4xIYY/edit?usp=sharing • Recruit patients for Food Pharmacy research study • Call and consent patients for study • Administer surveys • Grocery shop for weekend food items and help set up • Escort patients from the clinic to the Food Pharmacy • Assist patients with gathering food • Distribute educational material and collect data *Volunteering may include weekday and/or weekend work	
Infectious and Chronic Disease Department [ICCD]	The Infectious and Chronic Disease Department (ICDD), formerly known as the Latent Tuberculosis Initiative (LTBI), helps oversee latent TB infection screening and treatment, chronic hypertension management, and H. pylori treatment. In this department, volunteers work independently to lead patient visits, develop an assessment and plan for each patient, and gain experience with electronic health record documentation. The ICDD focuses on health conditions that require continuity of care and long-term patient follow-up, and volunteers get the opportunity to develop strong provider-patient relationships with patients who they see multiple times in clinic. During visits, ICDD volunteers provide in-depth health education and counseling, check for medication side effects, complete focused physical assessments, support treatment adherence, and address any other health concerns as needed. Volunteers gain experience presenting patients to HAVEN attendings	All Yale Medical, Yale Nursing, and Yale PA students are eligible to apply. Due to the in-depth on-the-job training required for our department, preference is given to students available for 6 or more shifts per semester.

	and finalizing a care plan to meet each patient's needs. In addition, ICDD volunteers collaborate with other departments at HAVEN to help screen all HAVEN patients for risk factors for TB, collecting labs as necessary.	
Interpreting [INTP]	Interpreters are critical in allowing us to care for our Spanish-speaking patients. One interpreter will be assigned to each clinical team and will accompany patients throughout the clinical visit. Interpreters will also be assigned to the Education, Social Services, Referrals, Reproductive Health, Behavioral Health, and Laboratory departments whenever possible. Without interpreters, the clinic cannot function, as 85% of our patients speak only Spanish. This is a great opportunity for those interested in health professions to get involved in clinical care. In addition to medical team interpreters, we are also looking for volunteers who are able to serve as department specific interpreters. These positions have the added responsibility of interpreting for regular medical visits as well as serving individual departments' needs, like those of Reproductive Health.	Anyone who is fluent in Spanish. Spanish skills will be evaluated by our interpreting directors before you start. There is also need for fluency in the following languages: Hindi, Urdu, Bengali, Arabic, Creole, French, & Portuguese
Phlebotomy [PHLO]	HAVEN has a fully functioning on-site laboratory that collects and processes a variety of clinical specimens. Volunteers perform venipuncture, collect urine specimens, and package these specimens to be tested off site at the YNHH lab. Volunteers work with SCTSs, JCTs, and attendings to provide the most appropriate tests for each patient. No prior experience is necessary. All volunteers for Phlebotomy receive venipuncture training with a phlebotomist at volunteer orientation and are evaluated before interacting with patients.	All Yale Medical, Yale Nursing, and Yale PA students. 2) Any students with prior EMT, EMS, phlebotomy, nursing, medical, or medical assistant experience.
Medical Debt and Insurance Counseling [MDIC]	Medical debt and health insurance status are often sources of stress for patients and deter them from seeking appropriate healthcare. The Medical Debt and Insurance Counseling volunteers play a crucial role in overseeing the process of securing free care for patients. This process will involve speaking directly with patients to learn about their unique circumstances, completing and filing HUSKY & YNHH Free Care applications, as well as acting as a liaison between Yale healthcare facilities, debt collecting agencies, and HAVEN's Medical-Legal Partnership. Ultimately, volunteers will work to ensure that patients receive the best care possible without incurring debt and to reduce stress in patients' lives by eliminating existing sources of debt.	Any member of the Yale community
Oral Health Department	Oral health remains critically underemphasized within the broader medical field due to systemic barriers such as	Any member of the Yale community (prior medical

[ORHL]	the fragmentation of healthcare delivery, separations between dental and medical insurance, and persistent socioeconomic inequities in care access. The dental department at HAVEN addresses this gap by providing triage-based dental services to New Haven's underserved populations, thereby improving access to care and connecting patients with necessary long-term resources. The Dental Department volunteers rotate between two primary roles: medical scribing and logistical coordination. Scribes assist clinicians by providing onsite logistical coordination with other departments while logistical volunteers will follow the patients throughout their healthcare journey, coordinating with scheduling (PS) , referrals (Referrals), and finance (MDIC) departments to ensure patients are successfully booked for follow-up appointments and that those appointments are completed Medical Scribe (In-Person): 1. Determine Patient F.C./Insurance Situation on EPIC 2. Record Clinical and Referral notes 3. Process Referrals & communicating with other HAVEN departments 4. Coordinate Patient Flow 5. Track ORHL communications for HAVEN internal referrals. Logistical Volunteer (Remote): 1. Determine Patient F.C./Insurance Situation on EPIC 2. Communicate with MDIC and Referrals to ensure Dental patients have appointments 3. Follow up with patients and departments for scheduled/ completed appointments Work alongside directors of ORHL for expanding and executing the mission of ORHL.	volunteering and experience is appreciated but not required) Additionally, members who speak another language, primarily Spanish, will be prioritized but not mandatory.
Patient Services [PATS]	The Patient Services (PS) department is responsible for all communication between patients and the clinic. We provide a highly energetic and interactive environment, working closely with our patients and all other departments to coordinate the clinic days and provide a welcoming environment. A PS volunteer will meet with each new patient, collect his/her intake information, and discuss the services provided at HAVEN. In addition, PS volunteers track patient flow, manage appointments, and make patient phone calls throughout the week, thereby ensuring the clinic runs smoothly. During on-call weeks, volunteers can expect to spend anywhere from 6-8 hours on PS tasks (including clinic day).	Any member of the Yale community with at least an advanced level of Spanish

Medication Access [MEDS]	The Medication Access Department works directly with HAVEN medical teams and local pharmacies to ensure that each HAVEN patient can afford the medications prescribed. We provide financial assistance by covering medication costs over the phone or in person, arranging deliveries, and providing additional resources such as coupons. We coordinate with clinical teams to review cost-effective drug options, confirm proper ordering, and follow up with patients to confirm they have received their medication. In addition, directors are involved with ongoing sub-committee and department projects. Volunteers work both in person and remotely to coordinate with pharmacies, call patients, and collaborate with directors on various tasks.	Open to anyone, with both remote and in-person opportunities. In your application, please indicate if you are interested in volunteering in clinic, volunteering remotely or delivering medications to patients at home. No preference in application will be given based on your response; this is for planning purposes only.
Primary Care- Junior Clinical Team Member [JCTP]	JCTSs accompany patients through each step of their day at the clinic, working with an SCTS throughout the clinical visit. They are responsible for taking vital signs, eliciting the chief complaint and some history, updating the appointment tracker, and coordinating with other departments for patient care. Once a term, the JCTS's role will be to communicate lab results to patients under the guidance of the Clinical Advisor.	All Yale Medical, Yale Nursing, and Yale PA students who have completed 1 semester of their program.
Primary Care- Senior Clinical Team Member [SCTP]	The SCTS is primarily responsible for providing each patient's clinical care. SCTSs take a complete history and conduct a physical exam, develop a treatment plan with the attending, and write a note in the chart. General Primary Care: A minimum of 3 Saturday shifts is required for the term. General SCTSs are expected to serve at least one "on-call" SCTS shift during the term. This entails taking 3-4 triage calls from patient services during the week. Except for triage shifts, general SCTSs do not have any responsibilities outside of Saturday shifts.	Yale Medical students who have completed their Primary Care and Internal Medicine clerkships. Yale Nursing students who have completed their first specialty year including primary care, and Yale PA students who have completed three rotations including Primary Care or Medicine. Yale MD/PhD students who have completed their first 4 clerkships.

QA/QI (Quality Assurance/ Quality Improvement) [QAQI]	The QA/QI department helps drive HAVEN toward its mission through project-based improvements and/or research-based investigations of clinic processes and quality. QA/QI volunteers undertake 1-2 projects per term and get the unique opportunity to interface with other departments to guide changes that impact daily clinic operations. Projects range from analyzing efficacy of new disease management programs, to streamlining the patient intake process, to analyzing clinical outcomes, etc. Time commitment ranges from 2-6 hours/week, depending on your project load. Meetings occur throughout the week depending on volunteer schedules; however, we do not require volunteers to regularly attend clinic days outside of occasional shadowing events, unless required by the volunteer's project(s) - this is <i>mostly</i> a virtual position!	Any member of the Yale community; This is not necessary to be a volunteer, but we are looking for some fluent Spanish speakers and some individuals with strong statistical background due to project-specific needs.
Referrals [REFF]	Referrals volunteers connect HAVEN patients to specialty care (radiology, gastroenterology, etc.), coordinating between clinical offices, patients, and HAVEN providers. Volunteers are critical in ensuring that patients can be seen for conditions that fall outside of HAVEN's scope. Volunteers will work with the co-directors to ensure that patients do not face barriers to attending their appointments and are not lost to follow up. The commitment typically ranges from 1-3 hr/week – but can be flexible based on your schedule and the number of referrals placed on a given week. Most of the work is done remotely, but volunteers interested in coming in-person will have that opportunity as well.	Any member of the Yale community Being Spanish speaking is a good benefit, but absolutely not required!
Reproductive Health – Senior Clinical Team Member [SCTS]	Reproductive Health clinical volunteers provide a wide variety of services to HAVEN patients including pelvic exams, pap smears, endometrial biopsies, breast exams, IUD and Nexplanon insertion and removal, provision and counseling on contraceptive methods, STI testing, and gender affirming care or menopause hormone replacement therapy. Generally, the department evaluates any reproductive health concern, orders diagnostic testing (labs, imaging) and provides treatment (medication or referral to specialized care). They also provide referrals for mammograms, ultrasounds, colposcopy and other more specialized gynecologic care. RHD clinical teams are made up of both JCTs and SCTs.	Yale Medical, Nursing*, and PA students who have completed at least one clinical rotation in OB/GYN or reproductive health. *Yale Nursing students without a completed reproductive health rotation may apply, if they have taken coursework in reproductive health (i.e., Women's Health I). RHD SCTs are expected to

	The responsibilities of an RHD SCTS are similar to those of a primary care SCTS (see above) with an additional emphasis on reproductive health related topics and trauma-informed care. Occasionally, RHD SCTSs also: 1. If trained, perform pelvic exams, pap smears, Depo shots, and vaccines (licensed RNs) with attending supervision. 2. Assist attending with procedures (IUD/Nexplanon placement/removal, endometrial biopsies, etc.); and 3. Instruct patients on how to collect point-of-care urine testing (e.g. UA or Urine bhCG) or do self-swabs for Vaginitis/vaginitis or STI panel swabs collected in-clinic. Unlike primary care SCTSs, RHD SCTSs do not take triage calls during the week. All RHD SCTS responsibilities are limited to Saturday Clinic.	volunteer in-person on Saturdays that they're assigned. New SCTSs will have a training shift (see only 1 patient that is medically straightforward, to learn the HAVEN workflow).
Reproductive Health – Junior Clinical Team Member [JCTS]	Reproductive Health clinical volunteers provide a wide variety of services to HAVEN patients including pelvic exams, pap smears, endometrial biopsies, breast exams, IUD and Nexplanon insertion and removal, provision and counseling on contraceptive methods, STI testing, and gender affirming care or menopause hormone replacement therapy. Generally, the department evaluates any reproductive health concern, orders diagnostic testing (labs, imaging) and provides treatment (medication or referral to specialized care in the Yale Medicine / YNHH system). They also provide referrals for mammograms, ultrasounds, colposcopy and other more specialized gynecologic care. RHD clinical teams are made up of both JCTSs and SCTSs. The responsibilities of an RHD JCTS are similar to those of a primary care JCTS (see above) with assisting in history taking & performing a general (non-sensitive) physical with the SCTS, with an additional emphasis on reproductive health-related topics/chief concerns and trauma-informed care. Maintenance of RHD inventory/supply cart for procedures and pelvic exams, room set up and break down are also part of the role.	All Yale Medical, Yale Nursing, and Yale PA students who have completed 1 semester of their program. RHD JCTSs are expected to volunteer in-person on Saturdays that they're assigned.
Social Services [SOSE]	Social Services (SS) volunteers help address the social and financial context surrounding our patients' health by connecting them with valuable community resources and helping them to apply for a variety of public and private programs. As a volunteer, you will learn how to screen for important issues like food and housing insecurity, immigration and housing difficulties, and more. You will then work with SS Directors to tailor a comprehensive plan for patients to access available resources like food	,

	assistance, energy assistance, and English language classes. You will also collaborate closely with volunteers in other HAVEN departments (i.e., Medical Debt and Insurance Counseling, Medical-Legal Partnership) to ensure our patients receive quality care. SS volunteers also have the opportunity to work on small-group community outreach projects.	
Vaccine Administrator [VADM]	Vaccine administrators administer vaccines to patients during scheduled appointments. They work alongside the vaccine coordinators to confirm contraindications and ensure that each patient is eligible to receive the appropriate vaccine(s). Administrators also provide vaccine education throughout the appointment, addressing any questions or concerns, and promoting patient comfort and confidence in the vaccination process.	Any Yale student/affiliate/community member who is licensed as an RN, APP, or otherwise certified to give vaccines. Must have a U.S. license.
Vaccine Coordinator [VADC]	Vaccine coordinators play an instrumental role in managing the administrative aspects of vaccine appointments. They are responsible for completing and maintaining vaccine administration documentation, including recording important information such as vaccine lot numbers and National Drug Codes. Volunteers also coordinate with patients to schedule follow-up appointments and ensure that subsequent doses in a vaccine series are received on time. Coordinators are expected to understand general Connecticut vaccination protocols and become familiar with the vaccines offered at the clinic so they can address common patient questions and concerns. In addition to their responsibilities during clinic appointments, coordinators may have the opportunity to promote vaccine education within the community by developing educational materials and participating in outreach initiatives aimed at connecting more patients with the vaccines they need.	Any Yale student or affiliate